**52. With reference to the guilds (Shreni) of ancient India that played a very important role in the country's economy, which of the following statements is/are correct ?**

1. Every guild was registered with the central authority of the State and the king was the chief administrative authority on them.
2. The wages, rules of work, standards and price were fixed by the guild.
3. The guild had judicial powers over its own members.

**Select the correct answer using the codes given below :**

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

**Ans. (c):** The guilds (Shreni) that played very important role in the ancient economy had their own seperate courts that settled their members' disputes. The 'guilds' itself ensured salaries, work rules, standards and prices. The craft guilds was headed by a Chief called the Jetthaka.

## • Rural Development

**53. How do District Rural Development Agencies (DRDAs) help in the reduction of rural poverty in India ?**

1. DRDAs act as Panchayati Raj Institution in certain specified backward regions of the country
2. DRDAs undertake area- specific scientific study. of the causes of poverty and malnutrition and prepare detailed remedial measures.
3. DRDAs secure inter-sectoral and inter departmental coordination and cooperation for effective implementation of anti-poverty programmes.
4. DRDAs watch over the ensure effective utilization of the funds intended for anti poverty programmes.

**Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?**

(a) 1, 2 and 3 only (b) 3 and 4 only
(c) 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

**Ans. (b):** In order to strengthen the district Rural Development Agencies and make them more professional in their functioning, a program called District Rural Development Agency (DRDA) Administration was launched on 1 April 1999 as a centrally sponsored scheme. The center and the state provide funds for this program in the ratio of 75:25. DRDAs secure inter-sectoral and inter-departmental coordination and co-operation for effective implementation of anti-poverty programs. DRDAs monitor funds received for anti-poverty programs and ensured that they are used effectively.

**54. The Multi-dimensional Poverty Index developed by Oxford Poverty and Human Development Initiative with UNDP support covers which of the following ?**

1. Deprivation of education, health, assets and services at household level.
2. Purchasing power parity at national level.
3. Extent of budget deficit and GDP growth rate at national level.

**Select the correct answer using the codes given below :**

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 1, 2 and 3

**Ans. (a) :** The Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI) based its estimation on education (years of schooling and attendance in schools), health (child mortality and nutrition) and standard of living (electricity, sanitization, drinking water, flooring of the house, cooking fuel and asset ownership). Equal weightage is assignments to the three lead factors such that weightage is proportionately split among the sub- factors.

## • Economic Planning and National Income/Budget

**55. The endeavour of 'Janani Suraksha Yojana' programm is -**

1. to promote institutional deliveries.
2. to provide monetary assistance to the mother to meet the cost of delivery.
3. to provide for wage loss due to pregnancy and confinement.

**Which of the statements given above is/are correct?**

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

**Ans. (a) :** The Endeavour of Janani Surakesha Yojna programmes are (i) to promote institutional deliveries, (ii) to provide monetary assistance to the mother to meet the cost of delivery. Janani Suraksha Yojana (JSY) is a safe motherhood intervention under the National Rural Health Mission (NRHM) being implemented with the objective of reducing maternal and neo-natal mortality by promoting institutional delivery among the poor pregnant women. The Yojana was launched on 12th April 2005, by the Hon'ble Prime Minister, Manmohan Singh.

**56. Consider the following :**

1. Hotel and restaurants.
2. Motor transport undertakings.
3. Newspaper establishments.
4. Private medical institutions.

**The employees of which of the above can have the 'Social Security' coverage under Employees' State Insurance Scheme ?**

(a) 1, 2 and 3 only (b) 4 only
(c) 1, 3 and 4 (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

**Ans. (d) :** According to the latest decision of Employees State Insurance Corporation (ESIC) Act-1948, now factories/institutions with 10 employees will also come under its purview, even if they are using electricity in the construction process or not. Employees of hotel and restaurant, motor transport industry, newspaper establishments and private medical institutions can get social security cover under the 'Employees Insurance Scheme'.



**57. With reference to National Rural Health Mission, which of the following are the jobs of 'ASHA', trained community health worker ?**

1. Accompanying women to the health facility for antenatal care checkup.
2. Using pregnancy test kits for early detection of pregnancy.
3. Providing information on nutrition and immunization.
4. Conducting the delivery of baby.

**Select the correct answer using the codes given below :**

(a) 1, 2 and 3 only (b) 2 and 4 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

**Ans. (a):** One of the key components of the National Rural Health Mission is to provide every village in the country with a trained female community health activist, 'ASHA' or Accredited Social Health Activist. They are selected from the village itself and accountable to it, the ASHA will be trained to work as an interface between the community and the public health system.

**58. 'How does the National Rural Livelihood mission seek to improve livelihood options of rural poor ?**

1. By setting up a large number of new manufacturing industries and agribusiness centers in rural areas.
2. By strengthening 'self-help groups' and providing skill development.
3. By supplying seeds, fertilizers, diesel pumps sets and micro-irrigation equipment free of cost to farmers.

**Select the correct answer using the codes given below:**

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

**Ans. (b):** The National Rural Livelihood Mission is an attempt to improve the livelihood options of the rural regional poor. The Central Government launched the National Rural Livelihood Mission (NRLM) in June 2011. This mission, launched for strengthening self-help groups in rural areas and for the prevention of poverty of the poor through them, started in the Banswara district of Rajasthan. Under this mission, the government plans to provide self-help groups at the village level as federations and provide them with a suitable base of better livelihood by providing them with profitable self-employment opportunities.

## • Agriculture, Industry and Trade

**59. What is /are the recent policy initiatives(s) of Government of India to promote the growth of manufacturing sector ?**

1. Setting up of National Investment and Manufacturing Zones.
2. Providing the benefit of 'single window clearance'.
3. Establishing the Technology Acquisition and Development Fund.

**Select the correct answer using the codes given below :**

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

**Ans. (d) :** To encourage the development of the manufacturing sector, the Government of India has taken the initiative to establish national investment and manufacturing sectors, facilitate single-window clearance and establishment of Technology Acquisition and Development Fund.

**60. In India, in the overall Index of Industrial Production, the Indices of Eight Core Industries have a combined weight of 37.90%. Which of the following are among those Eight Core Industries?**

1. Cement 2. Fertilizers
3. Natural gas 4. Refinery products
5. Textiles

**Select the correct answer using the codes given below:**

(a) 1 and 5 only (b) 2, 3 and 4 only
(c) 1, 2, 3 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5

**Ans. (c):** Currently, the Eight Core Industries comprise 40.27 (37.90% at that time) percent of the weight of items included in the Index of Industrial Production (IIP). The eight core industries include coal, crude oil, steel, electricity, cement, fertilizer, natural gas and refinery products.

## • Money/Banking, Tax System, Centre - State Relations

**61. The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) acts as a banker's bank .This would imply which of the following ?**

1. Other banks retain their deposits with the RBI.
2. The RBI lends funds to the commercial banks in times of need.
3. The RBI advises the commercial banks on monetary matters.

**Select the correct answer using the codes given below:**

(a) 2 and 3 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 1, 2 and 3

**Ans. (d):** The Reserve Bank of India is the Central Bank of India. It was established on 1st April 1925 with an authorized capital of 5 crore rupees. The Reserve Bank was nationalized on 1st January 1949. The Reserve Bank acts as a bankers bank i.e, the central bank, which means other banks keep their deposits with the RBI to control the credit. It gives loans to commercial banks and advises on monetary matters. Apart from this, control of foreign exchange, issue of notes, functioning as a bank of banks are also included in its functions.

**62. Which of the following measures would result in an increase in the money supply in the economy ?**

1. Purchase of government securities from the public by the Central Bank
2. Deposit of currency in commercial banks by the public
3. Borrowing by the government from the Central Bank
4. Sale of government securities to the public by the Central Bank

**Select the correct answer using the codes given below :**